PSHS STUDENT'S CODE OF CONDUCT AND INTERVENTIONS

PREAMBLE

The Philippine Science High School System (PSHSS), in order to cultivate a positive and nurturing learning environment that shapes students to high standards of behavior and lifelong learning, establishes and implements this Student's Code of Conduct and Interventions. This Code serves as a guide for SCHOLARS in embodying the values of integrity, excellence, and service to the nation, fostering a safe and orderly community where respect, discipline, and accountability are upheld, thereby building a strong foundation for exemplary citizenship.

CHAPTER 1: STUDENT'S CODE OF CONDUCT

Section 1: Core Values

1. **Integrity.** Students demonstrate honesty, fairness, and respect in both their pursuit of knowledge and their social interactions. They value responsibility and show respect for themselves, others, property, and the environment.
2. **Excellence.** Students pursue excellence by harnessing their fullest potential and nurturing a scientific mindset, critical thinking and creativity.
3. **Service.** Students are accountable, committed and patriotic in actively seeking solutions to societal challenges.

Section 2: Expected Behaviors

1. Students attend classes punctually and regularly, and they participate in co-curricular and extracurricular activities to support their holistic development. **(See Attendance Policy)**
2. Students wear the prescribed uniform or attire and practice good hygiene. **(See Uniform Guidelines)**
3. Students ensure that all submitted schoolwork, whether individual or group, reflect their own work, learning, and effort.
4. Students adhere to all guidelines regarding the proper and ethical use of external or artificial assistance, including but not limited to artificial intelligence and other related applications. **(See Academic Policy on the Use of Artificial Intelligence (AI))**
5. Students adhere to the policies and guidelines established by the school and their teachers for both in-person and online sessions.
6. Students conduct themselves appropriately and with modesty during both on- and off-campus activities.
7. Students communicate and act respectfully, refraining from the use of expletives and inappropriate actions and language.
8. Students use the school's name, emblems, logos, and other symbols responsibly in their correspondences and other communications. **(See Acceptable Use Policy)**
9. Students safeguard the privacy, dignity, and rights of institutions, groups, individuals, and themselves by acting responsibly and communicating thoughtfully when using information and communication technology, including in cyberspace. **(See Acceptable Use Policy)**
10. Students treat themselves, all community members, and PSHS property with care and respect, while sharing responsibility for creating and maintaining a healthy, safe, and drug-free campus. **(See Acceptable Use Policy)**
11. Students report any incident that may jeopardize the PSHS community to the authorities and assist in uncovering the truth of the matter to the best of their knowledge and ability.

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CHAPTER 2: RULE OF PROCEDURE

This rule of procedure is essential for creating a respectful and positive learning environment. By the principles of restorative justice and setting clear guidelines, the Code helps students understand appropriate behavior and the consequences of misconduct while holding them accountable for their behavior. This fair process ensures that all students are treated justly, supporting a safe and inclusive community built on respect and responsibility.

The procedure aims to address the misconduct by giving the student(s) involved the opportunity to be heard, take responsibility for their actions, repair the harm caused, and restore the well-being of everyone involved.

Section 1: Disciplining Authorities

1. **School Personnel**. The school personnel are the teaching and non-teaching staff of the PSHS System. They have the authority to implement guiding interventions for students, as provided by this Code.
2. **Student Conduct Officer (SCO)**. The SCO is a member of the teaching staff designated by the Campus Director to ensure a just and impartial assessment of student infractions. The SCO has the authority to evaluate reports of infractions and determine the appropriate action(s).
3. **Student Conduct Committee (SCC)**. The SCC is composed of a Chairperson and a pool of two (2) or four (4) members selected from regular employees by the Campus Director. The SCC reports directly to the Campus Director.
4. **Campus Management Committee (ManCom)**. The ManCom is composed of the Campus Director and Chiefs of the divisions.
5. **PSHS Board of Trustees (BOT)**. The BOT shall have exclusive and final authority in interpreting and implementing the provisions in this Code.

Section 2: Jurisdiction

The Disciplining Authority has the power to implement guiding intervention(s) for infractions committed in the following places or situations:

1. **On-campus**
2. **Off-campus**
   a. During local and international school-sanctioned events/activities, such as but not limited to games, field trips, student assemblies, competitions, exchange programs, immersion programs, conferences or forums;
   b. When a scholar commits a violation while wearing the PSHS uniform
3. **Virtual Space**

Violations of special laws shall be governed and processed following the guidelines outlined in each specific law. The SCO will assess complaints before making recommendations to special committees under these laws.

Section 3: Infractions

Infractions are actions that do not align with the established rules and regulations of the PSHSS. These infractions disrupt the respectful and positive learning environment that the PSHSS aims to achieve.

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In this context, infractions are classified as minor, major, and grave depending on the degree of harm caused to oneself, others, PSHS, and other institutions. Other factors and circumstances such as but not limited to intent, grade level, or repetitive misbehavior may also be considered.

Infractions may be corrected immediately by school personnel, while the SCO shall handle major and grave infractions.

Classification of Infractions

1. **Minor Infractions**. Minor infractions represent general non-compliance and cause disruption by interrupting or disturbing the normal flow of activities, often leading to a lack of focus for the student, or an uncomfortable learning environment for others.

   This includes but is not limited to, disruption or inattentiveness in classes and other school activities, non-compliance with the rules on uniform and hygiene, disrespectful language, loitering, and littering.

   School personnel who witness or discover a minor infraction shall immediately implement guiding interventions commensurate with the infraction committed.

2. **Major infractions.** A major infraction involves deliberate or negligent acts of non-compliance with school rules and regulations not covered by minor infractions. These intentional acts may result in any of the following: physical or psychological damage, damage to property, or reputation of the school.

3. **Grave Infractions**. A grave infraction involves deliberate or negligent actions that put the life or safety of oneself or others at risk, posing a substantial threat or severe disruption to the school environment. These intentional acts may result in any of the following: physical or psychological harm, damage to property, or the reputation of the school.

   Additionally, grave infractions include crimes punishable under the law, ensuring comprehensive coverage of any acts that threaten the safety, order, or legal standing of the school community.

Infractions that shall be referred to the SCO are, but not limited to the following:

i. Consuming or possessing intoxicants or alcohol on campus
ii. Damaging school property intentionally
iii. Engaging in any form of bullying or harassing behaviors toward others
iv. Engaging in dishonest behavior such as Academic Dishonesty
v. Engaging in physical altercations or causing harm to others
vi. Engaging in sexual misconduct or inappropriate behaviors
vii. Gaining unauthorized access to school information systems or school records
viii. Participating in any form of gambling
ix. Possessing items that pose a risk to personal or public safety
x. Possessing or using illegal substances
xi. Showing blatant disrespect toward school authorities
xii. Smoking or bringing tobacco products or other electronic smoking devices or paraphernalia onto school premises
xiii. Stealing property from individuals or the school
xiv. Tampering with emergency devices such as fire extinguishers or fire alarms
xv. Using or threatening violence against others

Section 4: Interventions

1. **Guiding Interventions.** A Guiding Intervention is an action taken by school personnel to address minor infractions and prevent further or repeated infractions. A minor infraction warrants a verbal correction or any of the following guiding interventions, or a combination thereof, commensurate with the infraction committed:
   a. written correction or advice;
   b. homeroom adviser-student conference;
   c. parent-teacher conference (PTC);
   d. reflective essay;
   e. confiscation or restitution (if applicable);
   f. a community/school service task that takes not more than one (1) hour to complete; or
   g. other guiding interventions recommended by the Guidance Counselor.

2. **Sanctions.** A sanction consists of guiding interventions and is categorized according to the seriousness of the infraction. Major or grave infraction warrants a referral to the guidance counselor or life coach, a character rating of Needs Improvement (NI) in one or more categories, and any of the following guiding interventions, or a combination thereof, commensurate with the infraction committed:
   a. Principal sanctions
      i. Community/school service for two (2) to sixteen (16) hours; or
      ii. Attendance at values formation activities for two (2) to sixteen (16) hours; or
      iii. Execution of Behavior Contract; or
      iv. Suspension from attending classes; or
      v. Suspension of Privilege(s)
   b. Accessory sanctions
      i. Homeroom adviser/dormitory manager-student conference; or
      ii. Parent-teacher conference; or
      iii. Reflective essay; or
      iv. Confiscation or restitution (if applicable); or
      v. Other guiding intervention(s) decided by the concerned disciplining authority.

Section 5: Termination of Scholarship or Non-graduation

A scholar may be recommended for termination of scholarship or non-graduation if they are responsible for:

a. Commission of three (3) Major Infractions during the scholar's stay in the PSHSS; or
b. Commission of one (1) Grave Infraction (endangers life of others).

Termination of scholarship - If the scholar is in Grades 7 to 11, the scholar may be allowed to finish the school year, but the scholarship will be terminated at the end of the school year.

Non-graduation - If the scholar is in Grade 12, the scholar may be allowed to finish the school year, but will not be conferred a secondary school diploma by the PSHSS and will not be considered a graduate of the PSHSS.

Section 6: Procedures

The PSHSS upholds the student's right to due process. The proceedings in this Code are designed to be restorative in nature and are not bound by court procedures. Additionally, all disciplinary proceedings, information, or collected documents may not be reproduced, shared, transmitted, or processed in any form or by any means and shall remain confidential or shall be stored in the Student Conduct Office to be used solely to resolve the specific situation at hand, except in cases when the law requires.

1. **Situational Assessment**
   a. A school personnel who witnesses or discovers a Minor infraction shall implement the appropriate guiding intervention(s).
   b. Anyone who witnesses or discovers a Major or Grave infraction shall report the incident to the SCO through an Anecdotal Report.

2. **Process for Minor Infractions**
   a. A school personnel who implements a guiding intervention shall inform the student's academic or homeroom adviser of the infraction for behavioral monitoring purposes. For community service, the academic or homeroom adviser shall help determine the appropriate tasks for the student.
   b. Any documents related to the guiding intervention, if applicable, shall be forwarded to the academic or homeroom adviser for reference.

3. **Process for Major or Grave Infractions**
   a. **Filing of an Anecdotal Report.** The filing of an AR shall be done within three (3) school days from the date of the incident or discovery. Failure to file the corresponding AR within the prescribed period means that it shall no longer be treated as a discipline case, except for incidents covered by special laws. However, the aggrieved party may still refer the incident to the SCO for proper intervention.

   b. **Conduct of Inquiry**
      i. **Background Inquiry.** Within three (3) school days from receipt of the AR, the SCO shall conduct a background inquiry to determine whether the allegation constitutes a possible Minor, Major, or Grave.
         a. If no Minor, Major, or Grave infraction is determined, the SCO shall dismiss the case.
         b. If a Minor infraction is determined, the SCO shall implement the appropriate guiding intervention(s).
         c. If a Major or Grave infraction is determined, the SCO shall proceed to a Preliminary Inquiry.
         d. If the SCO is directly involved in the case as a witness, complainant, or respondent, they shall inhibit themselves from the investigation. In such cases, the Campus Director shall appoint an ad hoc representative to oversee the matter.

      ii. **Preliminary Inquiry**
         a. Students involved in a case, along with their parent(s)/guardians, shall be notified in writing through a Notice of Preliminary Inquiry of the details of the incident and the schedule of inquiry. The notice of preliminary inquiry may also be given to the scholar, and the scholar shall require their parent(s)/guardian to sign the same.

b. The preliminary inquiry must be conducted in the presence of the parent or legal guardian only. Should the parent(s)/legal guardian fail to respond within ten (10) school days after the notice of preliminary inquiry is sent with reasonable efforts exhausted, the homeroom/academic adviser shall automatically accompany the scholar during the preliminary inquiry.
c. The preliminary inquiry must be conducted within ten (10) school days from the receipt of the Notice of Preliminary Inquiry, but in no case earlier than five (5) school days from receipt by the scholar/s involved of the notice of such preliminary inquiry, unless the concerned parties agree to conduct the preliminary inquiry earlier than five (5) days. However, for meritorious reasons, the period to commence the preliminary inquiry may be extended, subject to the approval of the Campus Director.
d. During the preliminary inquiry, a student shall be given the opportunity to defend themselves by presenting written/oral testimony of witnesses, electronic evidence, and/or object evidence. Students involved and/or witnesses to the preliminary inquiry shall also be accompanied by their homeroom/academic adviser, parents, or legal guardian only.
e. The proceedings shall be adequately documented and/or recorded.
f. If a Minor infraction is determined, the SCO shall implement the appropriate guiding intervention(s).
g. If a Major or Grave infraction is determined, the SCO submits the findings to the SCC for review and appropriate action(s).

iii. Formal Inquiry

a. Upon receipt of the SCO findings, the SCC shall determine if they will proceed to sanction or if a Formal Inquiry is needed for further investigation. This will depend on whether there is an admission of an infraction or if additional information is required
b. Students involved in a case, along with their parent(s)/guardians, shall be notified in writing through a Notice of Formal Inquiry of the schedule of inquiry. The Notice of Formal InquiryI may also be given to the scholar, and the scholar shall require their parent(s)/guardian to sign the same.
c. The formal inquiry must be conducted in the presence of the parent or guardian. Should the parent(s)/guardian fail to respond within ten (10) school days after the Notice of Formal Inquiry is sent with reasonable efforts exhausted, the homeroom/academic adviser shall automatically accompany the scholar during the formal inquiry. The proceedings shall commence in no less than five (5) school days from the receipt of the Notice of Formal Inquiry.
a. The FI must be conducted within fifteen (15) school days upon receipt of the findings from the SCO and must commence not earlier than five (5) school days from receipt by the scholar(s) involved of the Notice of Formal Inquiry unless concerned parties agree to conduct the investigation earlier than five (5) days. However, for meritorious reasons, the period for conducting the Formal Inquiry may be extended, subject to the approval of the Campus Director.
b. Any member of the SCC who is directly involved in the case should inhibit themselves from the investigation process. In such instances, the Campus director shall appoint an ad hoc in-charge to handle the matter.
c. The proceedings shall be adequately documented and/or recorded.

4. **Determination and Implementation of Interventions/Sanctions**
   a. If a Minor infraction is determined, the SCC shall submit its decision to the SCO within three (3) school days from the conclusion of the inquiry for the implementation of the appropriate guiding intervention(s).
   b. If a Major infraction is determined, the SCC shall submit its decision to the SCO within five (5) school days for the implementation of the sanction(s).
   c. If a Grave infraction is determined, the SCC shall submit its recommendation of sanctions to the Campus ManCom within five (5) school days for review and appropriate action(s).
   d. The Campus ManCom shall have fifteen (15) school days to review the case elevated to it.
   e. If the Campus ManCom determines the infraction as Minor, Major, or Grave infraction, it shall refer the implementation of the intervention(s) to the SCO.
   f. If the Campus ManCom determines that termination of scholarship or non-graduation is the appropriate sanction, the case shall be elevated to the Board of Trustees (BOT), through the Executive Committee (ExeCom). The BOT has the final decision to terminate the scholarship or non-graduation based on the discipline case.
   g. However, if the Board of Trustees finds that the infraction does not merit termination or non-graduation, it shall refer the implementation of the intervention to the SCO through the Campus Director.
   h. The notice on the decision involving Major and Grave infractions shall be served by the Campus Director through the SCO to the parent(s) or guardian within five (5) school days.
   i. The notice on the decision of Termination of scholarship or Non-graduation shall be served by the Campus Director.
   j. The Board of Trustees may intervene at any time for Grave infractions.

Section 7. Appeal Procedures

The decision of the disciplining authority is appealable through a written notice of appeal to the next higher authority, through the Office of the Campus Director, within seven (7) school days from the receipt of the formal decision. Failure by the appellant to file a written appeal within seven (7) school days from the receipt of the formal decision shall render the decision final and executory.

The decisions of the Board of Trustees shall be final and executory.

Section 8. Discipline Records

After the finality of decision of the discipline case, all documentation shall be kept securely in the Student Conduct Office.

Section 9. Amendments and revisions

1. The Board of Trustees, through the Executive Committee, may amend this Code at any time, either in whole or in part. Amendments may be necessary when unexpected issues arise or when errors or omissions are discovered. Examples include changes in the law, adoption of new policies, repeal of existing policies, discovery of drafting errors, or unanticipated situations or conduct.
2. If an unexpected issue requires prompt action, amendments to the Code may be made with the approval of the Board of Trustees.
3. This Code is subject to review as necessary.

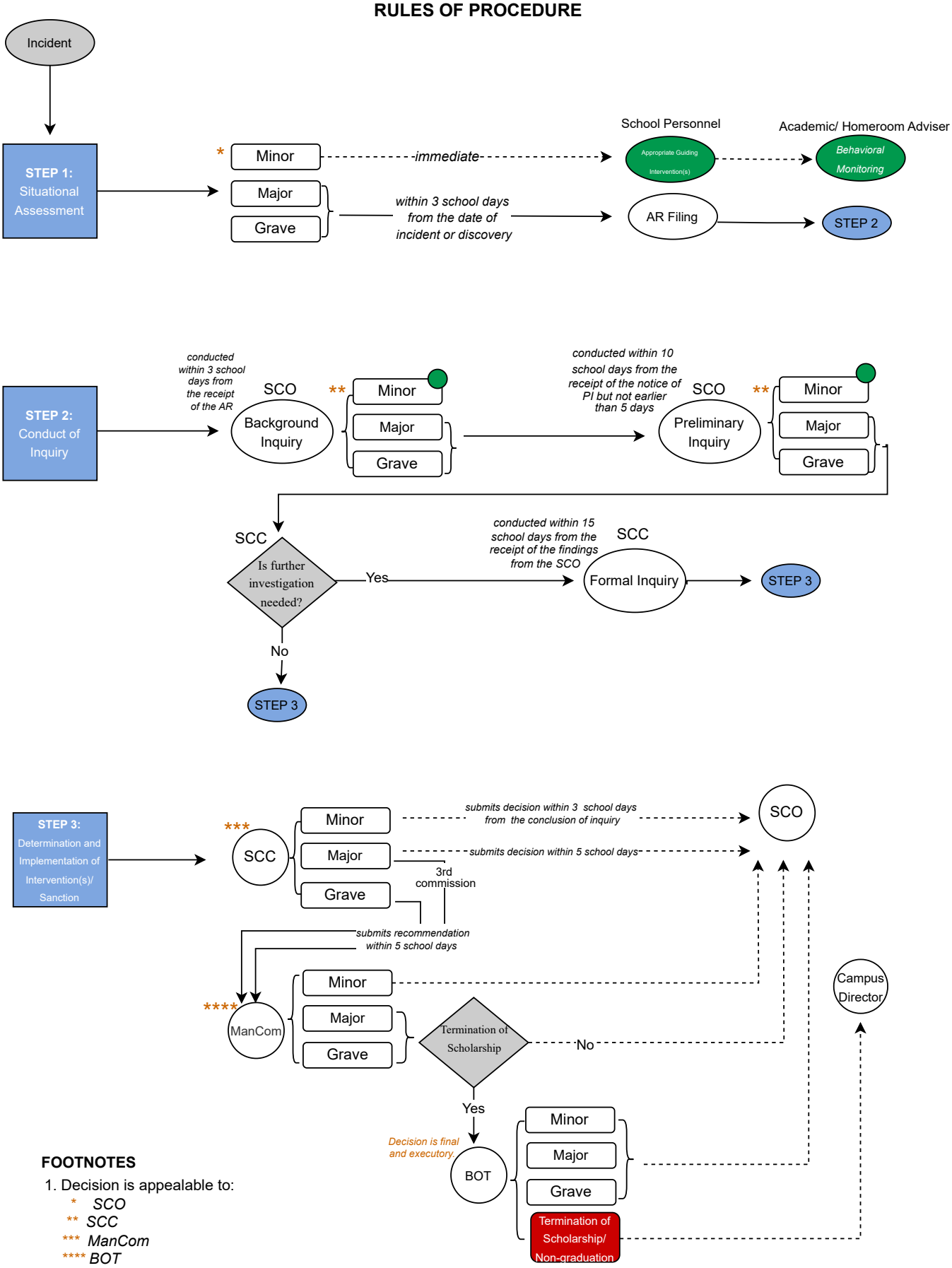
Section 10. Repealing Clause

Any issuance, rule or regulation and/or parts thereof contrary to or inconsistent with the provisions of this Code is hereby repealed, modified or amended accordingly.

Section 11. Effectivity

This Code shall be effective in S.Y. 2025-2026 following the publication in the Official Gazette of the Office of the National Administrative Register (ONAR) at the University of the Philippines Law Center, in the Official Campus Newspaper of the Philippines Science High School and in the PSHS website.

RULES OF PROCEDURE



FOOTNOTES

1. Decision is appealable to:
   - * *SCO*
   - ** *SCC*
   - *** *ManCom*
   - **** *BOT*
2. If no *minor, major or grave* infraction is determined at any stage of the procedure, the report shall be dismissed.
3. The BOT may intervene at any time for *grave* infractions.